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Overview

Lesson Brief for: University/College

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Project title: AI Literacy: Using AI Ethically in Higher Education
Project type: Interactive e-learning course
Target audience: First year University/College students
Estimated duration: 35-45 minutes
Development tool: Articulate Rise
Delivery: LMS / SCORM

The Problem

Higher education institutions understand that living in the digital age where AI tools and softwares are easily accessible to learners means that learners will inevitably make use of these tools. Learners are increasingly encountering and using generative AI tools to support their academic work. However, access to these tools does not guarantee an understanding of when and how to use them appropriately and ethically. Students may struggle to evaluate AI-generated information, recognise limitations and inaccuracies, distinguish acceptable assistance from inappropriate use and make informed decisions about disclosure and academic integrity. This course aims to guide students on determining how to use AI to support their academic work in a way that is ethical, appropriate and prevents them from intentionally or unintentionally committing academic misconduct.

Needs Analysis

Area	**Current state -** what are learners doing now?	**Desired Outcomes -** what should they be doing?	**Gaps -** what is preventing them from getting there?
AI Literacy	Students use AI tools but may not understand limitations	Students critically evaluate AI outputs	Critical AI literacy
Academic Integrity	Students may be uncertain about acceptable AI use	Students make informed decisions about appropriate use	Policy /application knowledge
Information evaluation	AI output may be accepted without verification	Students verify AI-generated information	Evaluation skills
AI Prompting	Students may use vagues prompts	Students use purposeful prompts	Practical AI literacy
Disclosure	Students may be unsure when/how to acknowledge AI use	Students understand when disclosure is required	Academic practice

Root Cause Analysis

Why does the problem exist?

Students may misuse AI due to:

- Not understanding institutional AI policies
- Not knowing what constitutes inappropriate use
- Not knowing how to evaluate AI-generated information
- Not understanding AI limitations
- Lack confidence in using AI appropriately
- Policies may be difficult to interpret

- Prioritising efficiency over learning

Assumptions and Constraints:

- The course will use a generic institutional AI policy unless a specific institution's policy is supplied.
- AI tools and institutional guidance may change; content will need periodic review.
- The course can build awareness and decision-making skills but it cannot on its own resolve inconsistent institutional policy, enforcement practices or unequal access to technology.
- The course assumes learners have basic LMS access and a device capable of accessing interactive e-learning content.
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Learner Analysis

The audience that will be completing the course are primarily, **Undergraduate students** with the following characteristics:

- Diverse levels of digital literacy
- Different levels of AI familiarity and usage
- Various levels of English proficiency
- Varying academic writing ability
- Different disciplines and assessment requirements
- May use AI informally before receiving formal guidance
- May perceive AI primarily as a productivity tool
- May be uncertain about institutional expectations

What do students already know?

- Referencing conventions
- What constitutes plagiarism
- The importance of declaring AI use

What do they need to know?

- Institutional AI policy

- Which types of AI tools for certain tasks (brainstorming; research support: editing/grammar)
- How to use AI as support tool instead of writing/thinking tool

What motivates them?

- Getting good grades
- Graduating without any academic misconduct incidents
- Improving academically

What barriers might prevent learning?

- Students who are averse to or do not intend to use AI tools may not see the point of the course
- Accessibility to consistent internet connection

What might cause resistance?

- Reluctance to use AI /wanting to complete the writing and research process from start to finish.
- Not making the connection that not planning to use AI does not mean you mustn't understand it.

Learning Objectives/Outcomes

By the end of this course, learners should be able to:

1. **Identify and selec**t appropriate AI tools for academic learning, research and writing tasks.
2. **Recognise and evaluate** risks associated with AI-generated content, including misinformation, bias, plagiarism and false citations.
3. **Apply** institutional guidelines for ethical AI use, including transparency, disclosure and academic integrity requirements.
4. **Use AI responsibly** to support brainstorming, understanding concepts, assessment feedback and independent study.
5. **Evaluate their use of AI** and make informed decisions that preserve their own critical thinking, academic judgement and ownership of their work.

Proposed Learning Solution and Design Rationale

A short scenario based interactive e-learning course will be developed to provide students with practical guidance on responsible and effective use of generative AI in higher education. This format is effective because:

- Short duration → reduces cognitive load
- Scenarios → allows students to practise decision-making
- Knowledge checks → provides retrieval practice
- Feedback → reinforces appropriate behaviour
- Interactive examples → allows learners to apply concepts rather than passively read information

The course uses scenario-based learning because AI-use decisions are context-dependent and require judgement rather than memorisation. Knowledge checks and quizzes provide retrieval practice and immediate feedback. The capstone assessment requires learners to apply the AI-use framework across multiple scenarios, supporting transfer of learning. The course is deliberately short and segmented to reduce cognitive load and accommodate busy first-year students.

Course Outline/Structure

Lesson	Format	Content & Activity	Duration
Lesson 1: The New Landscape	Tabs	Introduction to generative AI - What is generative AI - A brief history of AI - AI Tools for learning, research and writing. Prompting questions - what to ask and what not to ask.	5 mins

Knowledge Check	Sorting Activity	**The Interaction:** The learner sorts various actions into two categories. - Acceptable AI Use or Academic Misconduct	
Lesson 2: Ethical Considerations		Misinformation and Bias - How can AI push misinformation and bias into its responses? Plagiarism - Plagiarism in AI tools False citations	7 mins
Quiz 1	Multiple choice quiz	**The Interaction:**. Students are presented with a scenario and must choose a decision from 4 MCQ options to identify the issue and the appropriate solution/choice.	
Lesson 3: University policy and guidelines on AI use.	Accordion	The institution's overall position Academic integrity and plagiarism Transparency and disclosure requirements Citation rules Similarity checking (e.g., Turnitin) and AI detection Privacy, bias, and fairness What to do if you are unsure? Practical checklist before submitting	7 mins
Quiz 2	Multiple Choice Questions	**The Interaction:** Students answer 3 MCQ questions about university	

		guidelines/policy on AI use.	
Lesson 4: Using AI to Support Learning	Text, video content and worksheet	AI contribution continuum The continuum [Neglected, Dependent, Uncritical, Supported learning, Critical partnership] The continuum in practice Video - How to: Support learning using AI tools - Brainstorming - Explaining concepts - Feedback on assessments - Study Support Worksheet	12 mins
Lesson 5: Your AI Decision	Matching activity and Scenario Assessment	**Part 1: Matching activity** **Rise block type:** Matching Activity **Purpose:** To assess a student's ability to identify the appropriate use of each AI tool (as covered in lesson 1). **Instructions:** "Match each AI tool to the academic task it is best suited for" **Part 2: Scenario Assessment** **Rise block type:** Scenario **Purpose:** To assess a student's ability to identify appropriate use, maintain intellectual ownership,	10 mins

		evaluate AI outputs and act in line with academic integrity expectations. **Instructions: "**Read each scenario carefully and use the AI continuum framework (covered in Lesson 4) to select the best decision for the student to make in each scenario."	
Student Survey		Students answer 4 questions about their experience with the course.	3 mins

Assessment

Learners receive an assessment brief and consider using ChatGPT in several ways. The learner must decide which uses are appropriate, which require caution and which would constitute inappropriate use.

Assessment Alignment Table

Learning Outcome	Learning Activity	Assessment evidence
Identify appropriate AI tools for academic tasks.	Lesson 1: AI tools to support learning, research and writing. Lesson 4: Support uses.	Matching activity: match AI tools to academic tasks.
Evaluate risks in AI-generated content.	Lesson 2: misinformation, bias, plagiarism, false citations.	Quiz 1: scenario based MCQs.
Apply institutional guidelines for ethical AI use.	Lesson 3: policy, disclosure, citation, privacy, fairness.	Quiz 2: policy-based MCQs.

Use AI responsibly to support learning.	Lesson 4: video, examples, worksheet.	Worksheet and scenario responses.
Make informed AI use decisions.	Lessons 1-5: decision framework.	Capstone scenario assessment.

Evaluation Plan

Learners will be evaluated across three levels: **Reaction**, **Learning**, and **Behaviour**. This approach will assess both learners' experience of the course and their ability to apply the framework for appropriate AI use.

Level 1: Reaction

Evaluation question: Did learners find the course useful and engaging?

At the end of the course, learners will complete a short survey to provide feedback on the usefulness, relevance and engagement of the course. The survey will help identify whether learners perceived the content as valuable and whether the learning experience supported their understanding of appropriate AI use.

Level 2: Learning

Evaluation question: Can learners correctly identify appropriate AI use?

Learning outcomes will be assessed through a range of formative and summative assessments throughout the course, including:

- Knowledge checks after key topics to reinforce understanding.
- Short quizzes to assess learners' ability to recognise appropriate and inappropriate AI use.
- A capstone assessment at the end of the course, which consolidates all course topics and tests learners' understanding and application of the framework for appropriate AI use.

Level 2 evaluation measures whether learners acquired the intended knowledge, skills, and

attitudes during the learning experience.

Level 3: Behaviour

Evaluation question: Do learners demonstrate more appropriate AI decision-making?

Learners' behaviour will be assessed through their ability to apply the AI-use framework in a practical case scenario.. This will determine whether learners can move beyond identifying appropriate AI use and consistently make responsible, informed AI decisions.

Success Criteria

The course will be considered successful if learners can apply the institution's AI-use framework to realistic academic scenarios, achieve the required capstone assessment and report that the course improved their understanding of ethical and appropriate AI use. Completion, assessment performance, survey feedback and scenario response will inform future revisions.

Accessibility and Inclusion

This course will use clear, plain-language explanations, meaningful headings, alt text for images, captions or transcripts for video content. Colour will not be the only means of conveying meaning. Content will be chunked to support learners with varying digital literacy and language proficiency and key guidance will be available in a downloadable checklist.